REALITY CHECK TRACK

Progress when they investigate the Glitches, the nature of the train, try to remember, etc As the bar progresses, GLITCHES manifested by the NEURAL NETWORK get increasingly weird.

STAGE 1

1. The voice making announcements on the PA system is remarkably familiar to them.
2. The ads inside and outside all say things like: don't run, face them, destroy now, go back, I'm here; anything showing the number 12.

STAGE 2

3. They notice the cityscape outside never changes (spot on a specific building or landmark), like they are on loop or traveling in circles.
4. Whenever unconscious, PCs get flashes of themselves laying down with a strong light on their faces and a familiar face looking at them.

STAGE 3

5. The door to the next car leads to the opposite side door in the same car (the Pac-man loop).
6. Most commuters start behaving like they are in a glitchy computer game: swap faces, seats, don't react to the mess, repeat dialogs.

The train suddenly starts to descend at a very steep angle, causing an effect similar to zero-G.

When the track is filled up, they recall that THIS IS A SIMULACRUM—a virtual environment built for navigating highly complex neural networks.

Which Neural Network is this?
Why are they protecting it?
How did they forget?

Move on to Act 2.

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GAME MODERATOR ADVICE

- Answer the questions in *italic* collaboratively.
- Ask for details. *What kind of passengers do we see? What does your cyberware look like? Where did you get that sword from?*
- How often you telegraph the true nature of the Train (by checking the Reality Track or otherwise) will largely determine the pacing of the Score.
- Whether you choose to be more up front about the scenario's true nature or not, don't mind them figuring it out early. The Run is mostly about them dealing with the discovery. Besides, they can only take advantage of the Simulacrum when the Reality progress bar is filled.
- Once realizing they are in a Simulacrum, they might want to "hack reality". Allow them by asking for a roll and/or a Stress cost just like on a Flashback.
- Skilled adversaries act whenever the fiction says so. If PCs choose to interfere, their rolls determine how effective those actions are.

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THE CABINET OF CURIOSITIES

MYTHOPOEIA

CBR+PNK created by EMANOEL MELO, published by MYTHOPOEIA
CABINETOFCURIOSITIES.GAMES / MYTH.WORKS

MIND THE GAP

A /RUN FOR

CBR+PNK

CYBERPUNK

MIND THE GAP IS A STRAIGHTFORWARD CBR+PNK /RUN (SCENARIO) IDEAL FOR INTRODUCING BOTH PLAYERS AND GMS TO THE GAME.

THE WHOLE /RUN IS DIVIDED INTO THREE ACTS. EVERYTHING ELSE IS INFORMATION THE GM MIGHT USE TO ADJUDICATE WHAT HAPPENS NEXT.

SETTING [GM INFO]

The /RUN happens inside a TRANSMETROPOLITAN MONORAIL TRAIN racing through an endless urban sprawl. The PCs are tasked with protecting and delivering a Package. But something feels off.

Unknown to them, none of this is happening in meatspace. Instead, they are inside a Simulacrum—a virtual environment for navigating highly complex neural networks.

Their original goal was to protect the NETWORK from a virus, but it was overwritten when their minds were hacked.

Now they are unwittingly rushing to deliver THE PACKAGE to infect the Neural Network's core.

GET READY TO ROLL

Before players make their characters, present them the following OBJECTIVE:

DELIVER A PACKAGE TO THE EXTRACTION POINT AT CAR NUMBER 22 OF A TRANSMETROPOLITAN MONORAIL TRAIN.

After they are done, ask them to pick their LOAD* and present the STARTING SITUATION (ACT 1).

*In this scenario they won't select an ENGAGEMENT PLAN.

ACT 1: OFF THE RAILS

They begin in car 18, with a package in hands, a flashbang just detonated. From one side, the BLACK HOUNDS push their way through the crowd. On the other, an ELECTRONICALLY LOCKED DOOR.

Ask them: *What are you going do?*

From this point on:

- The NEURAL NETWORK slowly starts to intervene.
- Communication attempts with external sources only open opportunities for GLITCHES.
- If a PC dies here, they also die in real life.

ACT 2: UP TO SPEED

After further investigation (they've filled the Reality Check track) they find out the Package is actually a VIRUS and they were inadvertently delivering it to the Neural Network's core (car 22).

Who sent Black Hounds with the virus? Do they want to control or to destroy the Neural Network?

Their objective reverts back. Now they must either PUSH THE BLACK HOUNDS AND THE PACKAGE BACK TO CAR 12 or try to DESTROY THE PACKAGE.

However they approach the situation, THE PACKAGE itself will reveal its true form and fight back.

ACT 3: HOPPING OFF

Whenever they hop off (either through door 12 or 22), they wake up in an underground facility. Cables all over them, plugs in their heads, wires monitoring vital signs etc. Everything is makeshift, salvaged tech.

Is there anyone else with them?

Whatever happens now depends on how successful they were and how you answered the questions from Act 2. If they wake up in danger, ask what they do and resolve the scene from there.

When it's done, proceed to the ANGLE ROLLS.

OBSTACLES

BLACK HOUNDS

Paramilitary Squad
Slow, neural-linked weapons, assault gear.

At first they are there to make sure the PCs move towards Car 22. Whenever PCs linger around for too long, a new team respawns at the previous car.

BLACK HOUND COUNTERAGENT

Specialized Operative
Select according to the runners' approach:

- If they rely on tech/cyber, the agent will use EMP bombs, saboteur nanobots, analog weaponry.
- If combat, the agent has High-grade subdermal armor, riot gear, flashbang, flanking drones.
- Otherwise they will hack doors open and service robots or drones to push them through.

Contrary to the regular Black Hounds, this obstacle shows up only once.

THE PACKAGE (TRUE FORM)

Skilled Virus
Well-armored, 4 tentacle-like arms ending with claws, no discernible head.

When activated, their primary goal is to exterminate the runners.

NEURAL NETWORK

Will use its very limited control of the Simulacrum to alert the PCs, slow down their progress, help them fight the BLACK HOUNDS back and ultimately even try to kill them to prevent the delivery of the package:

- Manifest GLITCHES (see Reality Check on panel 3).
- Deploy help: surveillance or troubleshooting droids.
- Electronically lock up all doors.

GLITCHING COMMUTERS

- Middle-aged man in executive suit staring emotionless at a turned off digipaper.
- Young teen holding on a backpack, singing under their lips to a song at 1/2 speed.
- Gray one-armed robot with a LED screen for eyes. Asks "would you like some assistance today?" whenever anyones passes by it.
- Couple taking the very same selfies repeatedly.
- Same toddler in green overalls appears sitting next to different people throughout different cars.
- Person staring through the window, their reflection being someone else's.
- Elder man playing a game in VR goggles, oddly mimicking the gestures of a Black Hound.
- Faceless person talking business on the phone.
- Person standing up at the corridor, when bumped upon they start to weep and disintegrate.
- Two punks arguing, their voice come off as indistinguishable radio chatter.
- Woman sitting with a pet on her lap. Everytime she is looked at, the pet is a different animal.
- Person badly hurt from the conflict, unreactive of what is happening around them.

TRANSMETROPOLITAN MONORAIL COMPANY™
ANY DAY IS A GOOD DAY TO RIDE

P.A. ANNOUNCEMENTS

Throw in occasional announcements over the Public Address system. This is a limited medium that the Neural Network uses to communicate with the PCs. Use the ones below or improvise.

- Running can cause accidents. Please, do not run. Go back instead.
- The use of firearms is prohibited inside the vehicle. The Transmetropolitan Monorail Company thanks for your compliance.
- Today is a good day to ~~die~~ ride.
- Enjoy refreshments from our vending machines spread throughout the train.
- We will reach destination in ~~[illegible]~~ minutes.
- Fuck, [character's name].
- Please, secure your packages (or throw them through the window NOW).
- Dear passengers, please get the fuck out through car 12. Not 22. Twelve.

Scan the code to download the audio files or go to:

CABINETOFCURIOSITIES.GAMES